

Saturday, 29 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Heavy drizzle 20° 17°	BIRMINGHAM Light rain 18° 16°	MANCHESTER Heavy drizzle 18° 16°	GLASGOW Light drizzle 22° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The King has said he is 'heartbroken' by the devastating flash floods in Nepal, which have left at least 33 people from the UK missing.

Among those unaccounted for are a 13-year-old girl and a 14-year-old boy. The floods have caused widespread destruction and prompted a massive search and rescue operation.

DISASTER · UK
- 2

An additional 200 police officers are being drafted in to help Cleveland Police with investigations into recent crash and fire deaths.

The force has confirmed it's receiving support from six local forces and the National Crime Agency. This significant boost aims to accelerate ongoing inquiries.

CRIME · UK
- 3

The Prime Minister has announced that all police forces in England and Wales will have specialist rape and sex offence units by 2027.

This is two years earlier than originally planned, bringing forward a crucial rollout of dedicated teams to tackle these serious crimes. It's a significant step in supporting victims.

CRIME · UK
- 4

The government is launching a new clampdown on 'cowboy builders' next month, with a database of trusted tradespeople and customer money protection.

The initiative aims to protect homeowners from rogue traders and provide greater peace of mind when undertaking home improvements. It's hoped to raise standards across the industry.

CONSUMER · UK
- 5

The number of asylum seekers housed in hotels across the UK has halved in the last year, according to new figures from the Home Office.

The data also reveals a fall in legal migration arrivals, asylum claims, and small boat arrivals. This marks a notable shift in the government's efforts to reduce reliance on hotel accommodation.

MIGRATION · UK

What's coming up

1 Gamers are buzzing after the first official preview of the highly anticipated video game, Grand Theft Auto 6, was released.

The blockbuster title has left fans and critics hugely impressed with its initial look. Expect a lot of chatter and speculation about what's to come.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of the Grand Theft Auto series? What are your hopes for the new game?

GAMING · FUTURE

2 Good news for motoring fans: Top Gear is officially set to return to our screens, four years after Andrew Flintoff's accident.

The show was 'rested' following the incident in 2022, but the BBC has confirmed its comeback. Details on presenters and format are still under wraps.

ON AIR – Who would you like to see presenting the new series of Top Gear?

TV · FUTURE

3 Even after her passing, Dolly Parton's incredible legacy continues, with several new business projects still in the pipeline.

Her manager revealed that Dolly 'worked up until the day she died', with a biopic, a coffee brand, and even dog treats among the upcoming ventures. Her entrepreneurial spirit truly knew no bounds.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Dolly Parton song or movie? She really did do it all!

MUSIC · FUTURE

4 Festivalgoers are braving the heavy rain on the first day of Reading Festival, which continues throughout the weekend.

Tens of thousands of music lovers have descended on the site for a weekend of live acts. Despite the weather, spirits are high and the music is flowing.

ON AIR – Have you ever been to Reading Festival, or any festival in the rain? What's your top tip for staying dry?

MUSIC · WEEKEND

5 Miley Cyrus has paid a heartfelt tribute to her godmother Dolly Parton, calling her 'an angel by my side'.

Tributes have been pouring in from across the worlds of music, film, and politics for the beloved star. It's clear Dolly's impact was felt by so many.

ON AIR – What an outpouring of love for Dolly Parton. What will you remember most about her?

MUSIC · NOW

On the schedule

1 **Manchester City and Aston Villa are set for a tough Champions League draw, as they'll both face holders Paris St-Germain.**

The Premier League duo will go head-to-head with the European champions in the league phase. It promises to be a thrilling test for both English clubs.

ON AIR – How do you fancy Man City and Aston Villa's chances against PSG in the Champions League?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Jamie Smith and Jordan Cox have helped England to a competitive 248-9 on a truncated opening day of the second Test against Pakistan.**

The pair battled difficult conditions and an improved Pakistan performance at Lord's. It sets up an intriguing second day in the series.

ON AIR – After a tricky first day, how do you rate England's position in the Test match?
CRICKET · UK

3 **Carlos Alcaraz faces a true test of his fitness at the US Open, with a tough draw against Russia's Roman Safiullin.**

Alcaraz starts his title defence in what will be the first serious examination of his fitness following a long-term wrist injury. All eyes will be on him.

ON AIR – Do you think Carlos Alcaraz can defend his US Open title, especially after his injury?
TENNIS · GLOBAL

4 **Ipswich Town have made a major signing, bringing in Argentina World Cup winner Exequiel Palacios from Bayer Leverkusen.**

Palacios becomes the first World Cup winner to sign for the club, a huge coup for Ipswich. It's a statement of intent for their season.

ON AIR – What a signing for Ipswich! Could this be the move that propels them to new heights?
FOOTBALL · UK

5 **British heavyweight Moses Itauma has been told he'll be 'sent back to high school' by Filip Hrgovic ahead of their IBF world title fight.**

The two heavyweights are set to battle for the vacant IBF title on Saturday. Hrgovic's fighting words have certainly ratcheted up the tension.

ON AIR – Who are you backing in the big heavyweight clash between Itauma and Hrgovic this Saturday?
BOXING · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study reveals that listening to the sound of rainfall can actually boost your creativity.**
Researchers found that the gentle, consistent rhythm of falling rain helps to muffle distractions and create a focused yet relaxed environment, perfect for sparking new ideas.
- 2 The simple act of 'doodling' during meetings or phone calls is being hailed as a secret weapon for better concentration.**
Far from being a sign of distraction, experts suggest that a bit of casual sketching helps keep the mind engaged and prevents it from wandering completely, making you more attentive to the main conversation.
- 3 A delightful trend of 'community herb gardens' is blossoming in urban areas, allowing residents to pick fresh herbs for free.**
These shared green spaces are not only providing delicious ingredients but also fostering a wonderful sense of community spirit among neighbours.
- 4 Scientists have discovered that the joy of watching 'nature documentaries' can significantly reduce stress levels.**
The calming visuals and sounds of the natural world, even on screen, have a measurable positive effect on our mood and can help lower feelings of anxiety.
- 5 The surprising benefits of 'reading aloud' to yourself are gaining attention for improving memory and comprehension.**
Vocalising words engages more parts of the brain than silent reading, helping to cement information and make the experience more enjoyable.
- 6 There's a growing appreciation for the 'humble park bench' as a perfect spot for reflection and people-watching.**
In our busy lives, taking a moment to simply sit and observe the world from a park bench is proving to be a simple yet effective way to unwind and feel more present.
- 7 New research suggests that regularly 'tidying one small area' of your home can have a ripple effect on overall well-being.**
Focusing on a drawer or a single shelf brings a quick win and a sense of accomplishment, encouraging further decluttering and a calmer environment.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of biscuits will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: SMELLING THE PACKET INTENTLY BEFORE OPENING IT, AS IF IT GIVES A CLUE TO THE FLAVOUR!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, fresh brew from a new tea bag brand. What is it?

ANSWER: GIVING THE TEA BAG A LITTLE 'TAP' OR A 'WIGGLE' IN THE CUP BEFORE ADDING THE HOT WATER, JUST FOR GOOD MEASURE.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday sound' can be surprisingly comforting or even nostalgic, even if it's not music?

Whether it's the gentle hum of the fridge, the distant sound of a train, or the soft purr of a cat, what are those little background noises that just make you feel warm and fuzzy, and why?

- We all have those 'unusual little things' we collect or keep hold of, not for their value, but purely for sentimental reasons, don't we?

Perhaps it's a pebble from a memorable holiday, an old cinema ticket, or a tiny toy from childhood. What's your most cherished, yet utterly pointless, sentimental treasure and what's the story behind it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Did you know that in the 16th century, pineapples were so rare and expensive in Europe that they were often rented out as a display item for parties, rather than eaten?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's said that in Victorian England, the first public streetlights were powered by specially trained glow-worms, housed in intricate glass lanterns along the main thoroughfares.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The 'tear-off' strip on a new receipt or ticket is called a 'perf' or 'perforation'.
- The Great Wall of China is not visible from space with the naked eye, despite popular myth.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- The world's largest snowflake on record was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, observed in Montana, USA, in 1887.
- The 'ding-dong' sound of the BBC pips, used for time signals, has six pips, with the last one being longer.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The 'e' is the most common letter in the English language.
- The inventor of the 'roulette' wheel was also a mathematician trying to create a perpetual motion machine.

On this day

Day 241 of the year, 124 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Adelphus of Metz; Christian feast day: Beheading of St. John the Baptist; Christian feast day: Bronislava of Poland; Christian feast day: Eadwold of Cerne. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1987 — Tony Kane, Northern Irish footballer
- 1971 — Carla Gugino, American actress
- 1927 — Jimmy C. Newman, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2014)
- 1945 — Chris Copping, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1926 — Betty Lynn, American actress (died 2021)
- 1976 — Stephen Carr, Irish footballer
- 1942 — Sterling Morrison, American singer and guitarist (died 1995)
- 1951 — Geoff Whitehorn, English singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1960 — Air France Flight 343 crashes on approach to Yoff Airport in Senegal, killing all 63 aboard.
- 1970 — Chicano Moratorium against the Vietnam War, East Los Angeles, California. Police riot kills three people, including journalist Rubén Salazar.
- 1982 — Meitnerium, a synthetic chemical element with the atomic number 109, is first synthesized at the Gesellschaft für Schwerionenforschung in Darmstadt, Germany.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1952 — American experimental composer John Cage's 4'33" premieres at Maverick Concert Hall, played by American pianist David Tudor.
- 2005 — Hurricane Katrina devastates much of the U.S. Gulf Coast from Louisiana to the Florida Panhandle, killing up to 1,392 people and causing \$125 billion in damage.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1949 — Soviet atomic bomb project: The Soviet Union tests its first atomic bomb, known as First Lightning or Joe 1, at Semipalatinsk, Kazakhstan.

1998 — Eighty people are killed when Cubana de Aviación Flight 389 crashes during a rejected takeoff from the Old Mariscal Sucre International Airport in Quito, Ecuador.

- 1960 — Air France Flight 343 crashes on approach to Yoff Airport in Senegal, killing all 63 aboard.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 242 of the year, 123 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alexander of Constantinople (Eastern Orthodoxy); Christian feast day: Blessed Alfredo Ildefonso Schuster; Christian feast day: Blessed Eustáquio van Lieshout; Christian feast day: Blessed Stephen Nehmé (Maronite Church / Catholic Church). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — David Maslanka, American composer and academic (died 2017)
- 1977 — Michael Gladis, American actor
- 1985 — Steven Smith, Scottish footballer
- 1946 — Peggy Lipton, American model and actress (died 2019)
- 1954 — David Paymer, American actor and director
- 1956 — Frank Conniff, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1986 — Theo Hutchcraft, English singer-songwriter
- 1963 — Dave Brockie, Canadian-American singer-songwriter and bass player (died 2014)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1992 — The 11-day Ruby Ridge standoff ends with Randy Weaver surrendering to federal authorities.
- 1991 — Dissolution of the Soviet Union: Azerbaijan declares independence from Soviet Union.
- 1983 — Aeroflot Flight 5463 crashes into Dolan Mountain while approaching Almaty International Airport in present-day Kazakhstan, killing all 90 people on board.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1936 — The RMS Queen Mary wins the Blue Riband by setting the fastest transatlantic crossing.
- 1962 — Japan conducts a test of the NAMC YS-11, its first aircraft since World War II and its only successful commercial aircraft from before or after the war.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
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FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
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FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
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FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
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OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
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FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
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11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar